

PROJECT SYNDICATE DIGEST

October 2026

Compiled collection of all curated commentaries and analysis columns.

Generated automatically on 10/2/2026

Total Articles: 5

Table of Contents

1. America's Looming Debt Reckoning	by Kenneth Rogoff
2. Putin Is Testing NATO at Ukraine's Borders	by Anna Husarska
3. The OECD Should Be Reclaimed, Not Abandoned	by Kim Ruhl
4. The Sovereign Wealth Fund America Needs	by Steven Hill
5. The Hard Road to a Middle-Power Order	by Sophie Eisentraut

1. America's Looming Debt Reckoning

Author: Kenneth Rogoff **Published:** Oct 1, 2026 **Link:** [View Original](#)

CAMBRIDGE—America's fiscal position is increasingly looking like a train hurtling along a twisting mountain track. No one seems willing to slow down for fear of falling behind schedule and losing their job. Even if the train doesn't crash, it is worth asking: Why keep pushing it? Despite solid growth, the federal deficit is about 6% of GDP. Yet the option of slowing down does not appear to be in President Donald Trump's playbook.

2. Putin Is Testing NATO at Ukraine's Borders

Author: Anna Husarska **Published:** Oct 1, 2026 **Link:** [View Original](#)

LVIV—Jet-powered Russian drones recently hit a train in Ukraine a mere mile from the Polish border. The drone pilots, and their Kremlin minders, must have known that officials from Europe, the United Kingdom, the United States, and elsewhere had previously left Kyiv by train after participating in the Yalta European Strategy (YES) Annual Meeting, a sort of Ukrainian Davos. But the trains carrying former UK Prime Minister Boris Johnson, former Swedish Prime Minister Carl Bildt, former CIA Director David Petraeus, and former Polish President Aleksander Kwaśniewski, among others, were not hit. Had the Russians missed them intentionally or through incompetence?

3. The OECD Should Be Reclaimed, Not Abandoned

Author: Kim Ruhl **Published:** Oct 1, 2026 **Link:** [View Original](#)

NEW YORK—On September 30, the OECD marked the 65th anniversary of its founding. Like many other aging international organizations, it has developed a taste for mission creep, as we witnessed firsthand as former delegates there. That is why some US policymakers want to reduce or eliminate funding for the organization. But walking away from the OECD would mean abandoning capabilities that are becoming ever more important in America's economic competition with China.

4. The Sovereign Wealth Fund America Needs

Author: Steven Hill **Published:** Oct 1, 2026 **Link:** [View Original](#)

LOS ANGELES/NEW BRUNSWICK—OpenAI’s Sam Altman, US President Donald Trump, US Senator Bernie Sanders, and California Governor Gavin Newsom do not agree on much, yet they have all proposed that the United States create a sovereign wealth fund (SWF), seeded by stocks from AI companies, to cope with AI’s negative impacts. It is a good idea. Unfortunately, their proposals are woefully inadequate.

5. The Hard Road to a Middle-Power Order

Author: Sophie Eisentraut **Published:** Oct 1, 2026 **Link:** [View Original](#)

MUNICH—In his historic speech in Davos in January, Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney urged middle powers to confront an increasingly harsh geopolitical reality by joining forces to forge a “third path” between kowtowing to great-power pressure and going it alone. But when it came to defining this path, Carney’s speech outlined two projects of very different scope.